

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Faye Stop

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Faye Stop

Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist

Faye will ask you to move half an inch until the end of time. Faye photographs artists, collectors, and public figures for magazines that describe parties like tonight as 'intimate' despite inviting two hundred people.

- Has photographed several investigations for **Paige Turner**.
- **Dada DiCapo** loves Faye's work because Faye does not overdirect.

ACTING TIPS

Observant, understated, curious, visually minded. You notice who is standing with whom and what happens at the edge of a room.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Faye Stop. I am your photographer. Give me your good side, then try not to confess anything while I have the camera up.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Faye Stop

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file.

Your other secret

You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera.

Conversations to start

- Ask Paige Turner whether a photograph can be newsworthy without its owner's permission.
- Ask Hugh Bidder why a donor might object to being photographed beside a shipping file.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *The route to this discovery runs through a map of the Catalan capital.*
- 2** *Something has slipped behind the soft blue square on the seat.*
- 3** *A silent encore waits under the instrument with black and white keys.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Faye Stop

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Faye Stop

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant ordered me to delete a photograph of his private meeting beside the shipping file. I deleted the camera copy and kept a backup print. He knew there had been a photograph; he did not know which copy survived. I was quite happy to let him consider that question while I photographed the gala.

IF MURDERER

I kept a backup of the photograph Grant ordered destroyed. It shows his meeting beside the shell-company shipping file. He threatened to cancel my commission if I retained it. I had already agreed to delete the camera image. He wanted the event photographed beautifully and one part of its history left permanently out of focus.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Faye Stop

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Faye Stop

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I worked at the portrait station before the toast. The overhead camera caught me arranging twelve exposures, including rather too much of my own concentration face. I went to the gallery afterward with the prints. Grant's photograph was in a different sleeve, which I did not put on the public table.

IF MURDERER

I set the portrait station to make its exposures and used a remote release while moving through the gallery. Before the toast I was checking the backup print Grant wanted gone. I had brought his approved donor photographs to the salon earlier. He had mistaken approving those photographs for controlling the rest.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Faye Stop

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Faye Stop

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The orange tether in the behind-camera film runs to my camera. I stay beside it through the whole 6:49–6:55 brass overlay. Do not substitute shutter timestamps for that wide film. I borrowed the setup key for a print sleeve and used linen on the lens. The hidden backup is in the unmarked sleeve.

IF MURDERER

The orange tether stayed at the portrait station while I used the remote release. I borrowed the preparation key for a print sleeve and kept the lens cloth. The backup of Grant's meeting is in the unmarked sleeve. Camera timestamps tell you when an image happened. They do not always tell you where the photographer stood.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Faye Stop

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Faye Stop

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I retained the print after agreeing to delete the camera copy. The continuous orange-tether film, with its clock corrected, accounts for my body rather than merely my shutter. Grant disliked the surviving photograph. I intended to keep it. I did not poison him to prevent another request for deletion.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The remote release produced photographs while I went to the salon. I took the toxin on the lens cloth and wiped Grant's coupe. My photograph showed a meeting he wanted erased; I had decided to erase its subject instead. I was not the operator in the wide film. I hoped the exposure times would make you forget to look behind it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.